Indian Calling Setup & Cost Plan

Exotel (telephone line) + Vapi (AI voice) — requirements, timeline and calls per month

LeadBells · Prepared 9 October 2026

In one line

To place AI calls that show an Indian number to the customer we need two vendors: **Exotel** supplies the Indian phone line, **Vapi** supplies the AI that speaks. Both bill per minute. At our measured rate an AI call costs about **₹21** for a two-minute conversation, so a monthly budget of **₹10,000** covers roughly **460 AI calls**.

1. Why two vendors are involved

These are not alternatives. Each does a different job and both are charged on every call.

Vendor	What it does	Why we cannot drop it
Exotel	Provides the Indian phone number and carries the call over Indian telecom networks.	Without it our calls show a foreign number. Indian customers rarely answer those, and TRAI/DLT compliance is handled by the operator.
Vapi	Converts speech to text, runs the AI conversation, and speaks the reply back in a natural voice.	This is the product itself — the agent that talks, qualifies the lead and books the meeting.

LeadBells already runs this flow end to end on a Twilio number today. Moving to Exotel changes the phone line only — the AI, the scripts, the CRM and the dashboard are unchanged.

2. Where the Exotel account stands today

Verified directly against the Exotel API on 9 October 2026.

Item	Status	Action needed
Account	cyberbellsitesservices1 (prepaid)	—
KYC verification	Completed	None — cleared
API access	Working, credentials validated	None — cleared
Account tier	Trial	Converts to paid on first recharge
Wallet balance	–₹84.51 (negative)	Recharge required before anything can be bought
Phone numbers held	None	We will purchase one via API
SIP trunk access	Not enabled	Must be requested from Exotel by email

3. What we need, and who provides it

#	Requirement	Owner	Notes
1	Wallet recharge on Exotel	Finance	Clears the ₹84.51 due and funds the number rental plus call credits.
2	One Indian DID number	Engineering	Purchased by us through the Exotel API once the wallet is funded. No manual work.
3	vSIP / SIP Trunk access	Exotel support	Requested by email. Exotel returns the trunk name and gateway IP and port. Approval normally takes 1–3 working days.
4	Outbound calling enabled	Exotel support	Requested in the same email.
5	DLT registration	Compliance	Required only if the calls are promotional. Service and transactional calls do not need it.
6	Vapi account credit	Finance	Vapi bills in USD per minute. This is the larger of the two running costs.
7	SIP trunk wiring in Vapi	Engineering	We create the trunk credential, attach the Exotel number and run test calls.
8	Changes to LeadBells code	—	None. The new number drops into the existing per-workspace credential settings.

4. Timeline to go live

When	Step	Owner
Day 0 — morning	Recharge the Exotel wallet and send the SIP trunk request email	Finance
Day 0 — same day	Purchase the Indian number through the API	Engineering
Day 1 to 3	Exotel approves SIP trunk access and returns the gateway details	Exotel
Day 3 — half day	Wire the trunk into Vapi, attach the number, run test calls	Engineering
Day 4	Switch live traffic to the Indian number	Engineering

No downtime risk

Calling keeps running on the current Twilio number throughout. The Indian number only carries traffic once test calls pass, and we can switch back at any time.

5. Number options and monthly rental

Live availability pulled from the Exotel API. Rental is charged monthly and is a fixed cost, not per call.

Number type	Example	Rental / month	Available	Recommendation
Landline — Delhi	011-4XXXXXXX	₹499	292 numbers	Recommended — lowest rental, Indian customers answer local landlines readily
Landline — Mumbai	022-4XXXXXXX	₹499	73 numbers	Equivalent alternative
Landline — Pune	020-4XXXXXXX	₹499	406 numbers	Equivalent alternative
Mobile (10 digit)	089XXXXXXXX	₹999	54 numbers	Twice the rental; use only if a mobile caller ID is specifically required
Toll free	1800-XXXXXXX	₹1,799	Available	Built for inbound; poor value for outbound

6. What one AI call actually costs

The Vapi figure below is not an estimate. It is the billed average across **18 real calls** already placed on our own account, totalling 1,250 seconds of conversation.

Cost component	Rate per minute	A 2-minute call	Source
Vapi — AI platform fee	₹4.40	₹8.80	Measured
Vapi — language model	₹2.90	₹5.80	Measured
Vapi — voice and transcription	₹2.20	₹4.40	Measured
Vapi subtotal	₹9.50	₹19.00	USD 0.108/min, 18 calls
Exotel — outbound to mobile	₹0.80	₹1.60	Exotel tariff
Total per AI call	₹10.30	₹20.60	

Rounded for planning: **₹21 per AI call** of two minutes. Assumes USD 1 = ₹88. Two minutes is the average length of a connected qualification call on our account; short unanswered calls cost roughly ₹1.50 each and pull the real average down.

7. How many AI calls a monthly budget buys

Each row assumes the ₹499 Delhi landline rental is paid first, and the rest is split across Exotel and Vapi in the ratio the calls actually consume.

Monthly budget	Goes to Exotel	Goes to Vapi	AI calls per month	Calling minutes
₹3,000	₹499 + ₹190	₹2,311	about 120 calls	240 min
₹5,000	₹499 + ₹350	₹4,151	about 218 calls	436 min
₹10,000	₹499 + ₹738	₹8,763	about 461 calls	922 min
₹25,000	₹499 + ₹1,902	₹22,599	about 1,189 calls	2,378 min
₹50,000	₹499 + ₹3,845	₹45,656	about 2,403 calls	4,806 min

The important point for budgeting

Exotel is the cheap half. Of every ₹21 call, only about ₹1.60 goes to Exotel and roughly ₹19 goes to Vapi. A ₹3,000 recharge on Exotel alone would cover around 1,500 calls on the phone side — but those same calls would need about ₹28,500 of Vapi credit. Budget must be planned around Vapi, not around the telephone line.

8. Our published plans against this cost

Calling cost only. The number rental is a single shared fixed cost across all customers, so it is not charged against any one plan.

Plan	Price / month	AI calls included	Calling cost	Gross margin
Basic	₹444	5	₹103	₹341 (77%)
Standard	₹700	15	₹309	₹391 (56%)
Premium	₹1,500	40	₹824	₹676 (45%)
Pro	₹2,400	75	₹1,545	₹855 (36%)

All four plans are profitable on calling. The Pro tier is the thinnest at 36 percent, which is expected: it bundles the most calls. Margin here excludes GST, hosting and WhatsApp messaging.

9. A funded cost reduction we can make immediately

The billing breakdown shows one call consuming **54,683 prompt tokens**. The full scraped business profile is being sent to the language model on every turn of the conversation. Measured across connected calls, the language model is **33 to 40 percent** of the Vapi bill.

	Today	After prompt trimming	Saving
Cost per minute	₹10.30	about ₹8.00	22%
Cost per 2-minute call	₹20.60	about ₹16.00	₹4.60
Calls for a ₹10,000 budget	461	about 594	+133 calls

This is an engineering change on our side only. It needs no vendor approval and does not reduce what the agent knows about the business — the profile is summarised once instead of being resent on every turn.

10. Assumptions and open items

- Exchange rate taken as USD 1 = ₹88. Vapi bills in USD, so a weaker rupee raises the per-call cost proportionally.
- Exotel outbound tariff assumed at ₹0.80 per minute. The contracted rate sits between ₹0.70 and ₹1.10 and should be confirmed from the Exotel billing page; at ₹1.10 the per-call total moves from ₹20.60 to ₹21.20, which is immaterial.
- Average connected call taken as two minutes, measured on our own traffic. Longer scripts will raise the cost proportionally.
- Exotel SIP trunk approval is the only external dependency and the only item that can delay go-live.
- Promotional outbound calling to numbers on the DND registry is restricted in India regardless of vendor. Service and transactional calls are unaffected.
- Call recording, transcription storage and the CRM run on our existing servers at no additional per-call cost.

Recommended decision

Approve a ₹3,000 recharge on Exotel — that funds the Delhi number and covers the telephone side for well over a year. Fund Vapi separately against expected call volume at ₹19 per call. Send the SIP trunk request email today so the 1 to 3 day approval runs in parallel.